

Chapter 181 Part 1: Extra Story 4-1

After Liang Shi said at the awards ceremony that she planned to film some sweet dramas next, scripts soon came knocking at her door.

A Best Actress lowering her status to film sweet dramas was practically a blessing for audiences' eyes.

But for Liang Shi, it didn't matter much. She didn't really care about status. The endorsements she had were already substantial enough—she was endorsing a globally top luxury brand under the Shen family, as well as endorsements from Dongheng's side.

All the haute couture she wore to awards ceremonies and galas was sent directly to her home; she never needed to worry about that.

Liang Shi simply treated acting as a hobby.

Some things were indeed strange. When you treat something as a career to strive for, you feel like it's very difficult to do and the shore of your dreams is particularly hard to reach. But if you treat it as a hobby, because expectations drop dramatically, you can accomplish it without much effort.

Just like Liang Shi winning Best Actress.

She simply liked the script of "You in My Memory" and liked the role.

This time, one of the scripts that came to her was her company's self-produced drama, "Listening to the Wind Say I Love You."

Just from the name, you could tell it was a sweet drama.

It was still the standard dual female lead setup, without any melodrama or misunderstandings. Every episode found different ways to sprinkle sweetness.

There weren't many kiss scenes or bed scenes. It wasn't that kind of manufactured sugar type of sweet drama, but rather a story about how an intangible cultural heritage inheritor¹ progresses and changes amid the tide of modernization. The romance happens in the process of progressing and changing.

The feelings between the two characters in the script were all conveyed through glances and small gestures—like hooking pinkies, suddenly leaning in close to talk, foreheads touching. There were all kinds of ways to express love.

After reading the script, Liang Shi also chose to take it on.

Chaochao and Mumu had also reached kindergarten age. Liang Shi and the others didn't pick and choose, just sent them directly to a kindergarten near their home.

These two were both mischievously clever, and they caused trouble on the very first day of kindergarten.

Mumu was more lively, and her desk mate was a little boy who loved to cry.

Because it was the first day of kindergarten, the little boy couldn't bear to be away from his mom and kept crying non-stop. When the teacher asked them to get to know their new classmates, he wouldn't move, just kept crying. Mumu frowned: "Aiya, stop crying. If you keep crying, you'll become ugly."

The little boy sobbed, "Mind your own business."

Mumu comforted him: "Your mom will come when school ends. You need to listen to the teacher now."

The little boy ignored her and continued crying.

So she raised her hand to signal the teacher: "Teacher, my desk mate is ignoring me. Can I switch desk mates? I want Sheng Yan."

Sheng Yan, whose full name was called, was in the middle of introducing herself to her desk mate, a little girl. They were almost done. The little girl had two little pigtails, was milky white, and spoke in a small voice, but Sheng Yan was encouraging her to speak louder. The two were getting along fairly smoothly.

When Mumu called out like this, the whole class turned their eyes toward them.

The teacher immediately ran over, "Little friend Shen Xuan, what's wrong?"

"He keeps crying and crying." Shen Xuan covered one ear, "My ear hurts from the noise. I want to sit with Sheng Yan."

When they had dropped them off at kindergarten, Xu Qingzhu had specifically communicated with the teacher, hoping the two children could be in the same class but not sit together as desk mates.

Being in kindergarten could also help develop both their social skills.

Mumu was doing okay, but for Chaochao, this was probably the best opportunity to help her make friends—preferably with some more lively children. Otherwise, Chaochao's personality was too reserved. As for Mumu, she needed to be paired with someone who could help her calm down.

The teacher had arranged it this way, but now Mumu was openly complaining about her desk mate, putting the teacher in a difficult position.

Before the teacher could resolve it, Sheng Yan said: "Teacher, I don't want to sit with classmate Shen Xuan."

Mumu: "?"

The teacher immediately tried to soothe Shen Xuan, reasoning with her, hoping she could encourage her desk mate.

The result was Shen Xuan saying to the still crying little boy: "Can't you be a bit stronger? This is really ugly, you know."

Hearing this, the little boy cried even harder.

His reason was that Shen Xuan was being mean to him, and he also wanted to switch desk mates.

Shen Xuan got anxious, widened her eyes and slapped the desk: "When was I mean to you?"

The little boy covered his face: "Right... now..."

He was already crying so hard he could barely breathe.

And so, Shen Xuan was quietly spoken to by the teacher—it couldn't even be called a reprimand.

But Shen Xuan was feeling gloomy. When the little boy was about to go out, she stuck out her foot and tripped him. The little boy fell to the ground and cried that he wanted to go home.

Shen Xuan: "....."

Because the other child had bruised his forehead, the teacher kept both sets of parents after school, explained the situation, and mediated.

Shen Xuan also knew she had done wrong. She apologized to him with her head drooping.

The other parent was also reasonable and didn't make a big fuss. They just said their child was somewhat introverted and had delicate skin that bruised easily with just a little pinch, so they hoped the new desk mate could be more careful and not bully him.

That day, both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu came to pick them up. After apologizing to the other parent, they took Shen Xuan and Sheng Yan home.

The atmosphere on the way home was gloomy. Shen Xuan sat in the back of the car curled up into a ball, as if she had been bullied.

As soon as they entered the house, Xu Qingzhu asked Liang Shi: "You or me?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi glanced at Shen Xuan, who was wearing a pink backpack with her head hanging down. She already couldn't bear it, but she knew this matter definitely required serious discipline. She was also afraid that once she saw Shen Xuan's tears, she wouldn't be able to hold firm.

Before she could answer, Xu Qingzhu had already seen through her soft-heartedness and sighed: "I'll do it."

Then she crossed her arms and looked at Shen Xuan, "Shen Xuan, come with me."

She deliberately called her by her full name very seriously.

Mumu actually shuddered in fright. When she looked up at Xu Qingzhu, she was extremely guilty, the corners of her eyes already red, like a little white rabbit.

The little one had never experienced something like this before. After that child fell, when he cried, she had also cried along.

Because she knew she had done something wrong.

On the way to the study following Xu Qingzhu, she had already started to sob, terrified.

After Xu Qingzhu brought her into the study and closed the door, she stood there and shuddered.

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1. "非遗传承人" (fēi yí chuán chéng rén) refers to an inheritor of intangible cultural heritage. In China, this is an officially recognized designation for individuals who carry on traditional crafts, arts, or cultural practices that have been designated as protected cultural heritage by the government. ↵

Chapter 181 Part 2: Extra Story 4-2

Sheng Yan and Liang Shi stood in the living room.

A few seconds later, Sheng Yan looked at Liang Shi: "Mama, is little sister going to get spanked?"

Liang Shi: ".....Your Mommy has always convinced people with reason."

The moment she finished speaking, crying could be heard from the study.

Sheng Yan immediately moved closer to Liang Shi, hugging Liang Shi's leg.

Liang Shi could barely bring herself to listen, but Shen Xuan's voice kept drilling into her ears.

"I was about to switch seats." Shen Xuan was also aggrieved: "It was Sheng Yan who wouldn't switch with me, wuwuwu."

"I didn't want to sit with that crybaby." Shen Xuan said: "He kept crying, and I wanted to cry too wuwuwu....."

Shen Xuan's voice came from the study. Liang Shi saw Sheng Yan lower her head.

Liang Shi patted her head: "What's wrong? Feeling sorry for your little sister?"

Sheng Yan shook her head, her brow slightly furrowed, "I'm thinking about whether I was right not to switch seats."

Liang Shi half-squatted: "What were you thinking when you decided not to switch seats?"

Sheng Yan pursed her lips and answered slowly: "Mommy said to keep us separated, because in our lives we only have each other, but at school we need to make friends. At home I yield to her, but... at school she needs to learn to yield to others."

Liang Shi didn't even know Xu Qingzhu had said these things to Sheng Yan.

Chaochao appeared overly sensible in everyone's eyes, so she could digest what Xu Qingzhu told her very well. It was just that her way of handling things was too hardcore.

A bit too rigid in her thinking.

Liang Shi suddenly asked her: "Don't you feel bad always yielding to her at home? Do you feel like the mamas only dote on her and not you?"

Sheng Yan thought for a moment and shook her head: "She's my little sister."

Just as they were talking, the doorbell rang.

Liang Shi picked up Sheng Yan in one motion and kissed her on the cheek, "Our Chaochao is too well-behaved. From now on, you can compete with your little sister—you don't have to yield to her in everything. See, she's become domineering outside, hasn't she?"

Chaochao let out a little laugh.

The door opened to reveal Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui, along with their little one Zhao Yijia, nicknamed Doubao.¹

"Jiejie."² Zhao Yijia was just over one year old this year and had only learned to talk not long ago. She was being held in Zhao Xuning's arms, and the moment she saw Chaochao, she immediately smiled, her eyes curving into crescents, reaching out her hands wanting Chaochao to hold her.

Zhao Xuning immediately put her down and held her hand.

Chaochao also went over to hold her hand. Doubao immediately let go of Zhao Xuning's hand—in fact, Zhao Xuning reacted half a beat slow and hadn't let go first. Doubao was frantically pulling downward. Though she had no strength in her hands, she used all her might to walk forward, tugging Zhao Xuning along and making her take half a step forward.

Zhao Xuning said helplessly: "So you don't want me anymore now that you have your jiejie, is that it?"

Doubao walked off with Chaochao without even turning her head.

Shen Hui asked while changing her shoes, "Did Mumu get in trouble again?"

"Mm." Liang Shi said helplessly, "She's being disciplined right now."

"That tone of yours." Shen Hui glanced at her: "It feels like you're the one being disciplined."

Liang Shi: "....."

Mumu had cried until her voice was almost hoarse. Liang Shi truly felt sorry for her.

But there was no way she could go in.

She poured glasses of water for Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui, and had them sit in the living room. "Where are big sister and Gu Yixue?"

"Sister-in-law's flight landed today, big sister went to pick her up." Shen Hui said.

Liang Shi told them about what had happened at kindergarten today.

Zhao Xuning nodded: "She does need to be disciplined."

But then Shen Hui glanced at her, and Zhao Xuning immediately pressed her lips together.

Shen Hui scoffed lightly: "Let's see if you'd be willing to discipline her when it's your own daughter."

Zhao Xuning: "When it comes to matters of principle, I can still tell right from wrong."

Shen Hui didn't believe her at all, "You have a filter for your daughter. How could your daughter ever do anything wrong? Of course she couldn't."

Zhao Xuning wrapped her arm around her waist and leaned close to her ear, speaking in a low voice: "Isn't she your daughter too?"

Shen Hui: ".....She's nothing like me."

Liang Shi was already used to their interaction style and covered her eyes, teasing, "Dr. Zhao, take it easy."

Zhao Xuning glanced at her: "Hm?"

With a hint of threat.

But Liang Shi wasn't afraid and called out leisurely: "Second sister."

Shen Hui reached back and pinched Zhao Xuning's waist: "Speak properly."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Zhao Xuning said with an aggrieved expression: "She didn't call me anything."

Shen Hui: "?"

"Second sister-in-law?" Liang Shi raised an eyebrow.

Zhao Xuning nodded: "That's more like it."

Liang Shi rolled her eyes: "My god, Zhao Xuning, you really care about this."

Zhao Xuning: "What else?"

Liang Shi scoffed lightly and only asked after entering the kitchen: "What do you want to eat tonight?"

"Anything's fine." Shen Hui rolled up her sleeves intending to help, but was held back by Zhao Xuning, "You go check on Doubao, I'll do it."

She then went into the kitchen to help Liang Shi.

Liang Shi had just taken out the kitchen knife, preparing to cut vegetables, when Zhao Xuning came in and said: "You're really so impolite....."

Before she could finish, Liang Shi turned around, the knife blade pointing right at Zhao Xuning: "The knife is in my hand. I advise you to be careful."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Two seconds later, Zhao Xuning turned her head, "A-Hui, your little sister is bullying me."

Liang Shi: "?"

Shen Hui's voice came from the toy room: "Zhao Xuning, don't bully her."

Zhao Xuning: ".....?"

1. "豆包" (Dòubāo) literally means "bean bun" - a type of steamed bun filled with sweet red bean paste. It's a cute nickname for children in Chinese, similar to calling a child "sweetie" or "muffin" in English. ↵
2. "姐姐" (Jiějie) means "older sister" in Chinese. It's commonly used by younger children to address older girls, even if they're not related. ↵